

Meleagris gallopavo

Wild turkey



Length 4 ft (1.2 m)
Weight 22 lb (10 kg)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location North America



The wild turkey is a large gamebird with bronze, iridescent plumage and a naked head with conspicuous blue and red fleshy ornaments. The male has a "beard" of hairlike feathers on the upper

breast. For much of the year, this turkey is seen in groups of around 20, but in the breeding season, the males set up individual territories. Each male mates with a number of females, courting them with tail fanned, wings spread low, and head held high, giving the characteristic gobbling call. The wild turkey is omnivorous: chicks take up to 4,000 insects per day; adults eat seeds, herbs, roots, buds, and flowers, as well as insects. To defend itself, it pecks with its bill, scratches with its claws, and buffets with its wings.



Callipepla californica

California quail

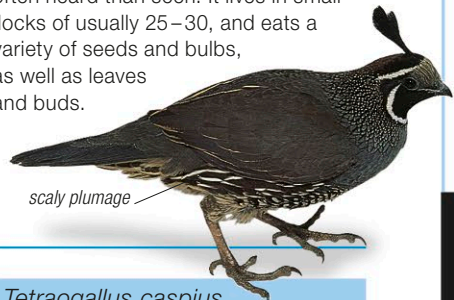


Length 10 in (25 cm)
Weight 6 oz (175 g)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location S.W. Canada, W. USA, N.W. Mexico



A long, black, teardrop-shaped crest, black and white facial feathers, and scaly plumage on the belly are distinctive features of this elegant gamebird. The female is smaller than the male, has a smaller crest, and is generally drabber in appearance. Shy and elusive, the California quail is more often heard than seen. It lives in small flocks of usually 25–30, and eats a variety of seeds and bulbs, as well as leaves and buds.



Tetrao urogallus

Western capercaillie

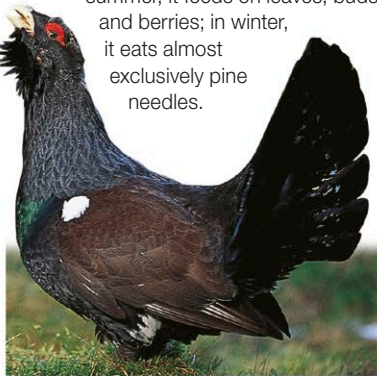


Length 32–45 in (80–115 cm)
Weight 8½–10 lb (4–4.5 kg)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location N., W., and S. Europe, W. to C. Asia



Males of this large-bodied grouse congregate at display grounds (leks) in their native northern forests, where they strut to display to females; their calls sound like a bottle being uncorked. In summer, it feeds on leaves, buds and berries; in winter, it eats almost exclusively pine needles.



Centrocercus minimus

Gunnison grouse



Length 12¼–20 in (32–51 cm)
Weight 2–4½ lb (1–2 kg)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Endangered

Location W.C. USA





The smaller of 2 species of North American sage grouse, this species was named in 2000 and is restricted to southwestern Colorado and southeastern Utah. It is—so far—the only new species of bird to be described from the USA since the 1800s. Male sage grouse strut in groups with inflated chest sacs and make drumming sounds to attract mates; they favor open country dominated by sagebrush.

Lagopus lagopus

Willow ptarmigan

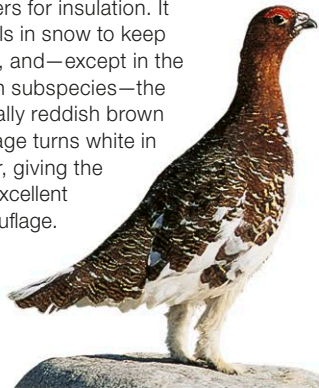


Length 15 in (38 cm)
Weight 20–25 oz (550–700 g)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location N. North America, N. Europe, N. Asia



This exceptionally hardy gamebird—of which there are 16 subspecies—is well adapted to life in the harsh conditions of the northern winter. Like other grouse, its legs and nostrils have feathers for insulation. It tunnels in snow to keep warm, and—except in the British subspecies—the normally reddish brown plumage turns white in winter, giving the bird excellent camouflage.



Tetraogallus caspius

Caspian snowcock



Length 23½ in (60 cm)
Weight Not recorded
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location S.E. Europe, W. Asia



Typical of the 5 species of snowcocks, this bird has mottled brown, gray, and white plumage that provides good camouflage against bare rock. It feeds in small flocks, and migrates vertically with the seasons, often descending below the treeline in winter.

Perdix perdix

Gray partridge



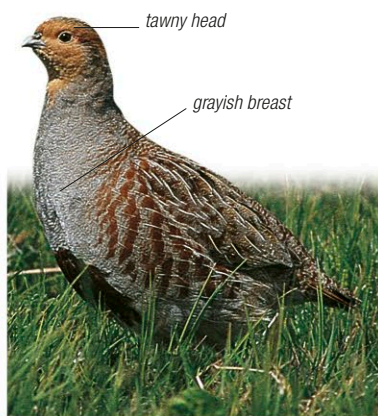
Length 12 in (31 cm)
Weight 11–16 oz (300–450 g)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location Europe, W. and C. Asia



The gray partridge is a farmland bird, feeding and nesting among crops as well as in pasture. It has a tawny head and grayish breast, and the male has a conspicuous chestnut horseshoe mark on the abdomen. Coveys of 15–20 birds live together in winter, but late in the season these begin to break up as

the males become more aggressive, even fighting with one another. Although changes of mate are common early on, stable pairs soon form, usually of males and females from different coveys.



Coturnix coturnix

Common quail



Length 7 in (18 cm)
Weight 2½–5 oz (70–150 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Migrant
Status Least concern

Location Europe, Asia, Africa, Madagascar



A small and secretive gamebird, this quail is heard much more than it is seen. The first sign of its presence is most often the male's repeated "whit wit-wit" call. During the breeding season, the male and female establish contact by calling, which means they can locate a mate while remaining

safely hidden. The common quail roosts on the ground at night in tight groups. Its diet is remarkably varied, and includes seeds, flower buds, leaves, small fruit, and insects and other invertebrates. This is one of the few gamebirds that migrates long distances; those that breed in Europe arrive in spring from Africa.

